

leadership potential.

A team will have only a handful of fit players, leaving many others unprepared to perform at their best. This creates a situation that is both dangerous for the future and can cause issues within the current team. This approach is common among many coaches and often leads to their downfall.

All teams face issues, problems, and drama, though good teams may experience less of it. The more unbiased training all players receive, the better equipped they are to perform at their best during critical moments or important tournaments.

6. Not learning with an open mind

Coaches want their players to be coachable, but often set a poor example of what that looks like. All team members need to be coachable, including the coach. Being too arrogant with limited knowledge can lead to self-destruction.

They might think they're smarter than their athletes, but that doesn't mean they're doing things the right way or are where they need to be. The best leaders are lifelong learners. Paying attention to and learning from others' good and bad decisions helps them grow. Listening to their players can provide insights they might otherwise miss. A humble mindset is imperative for learning.

7. Misunderstanding the situation's needs

Coaches are hired for a reason, but that doesn't mean they have all the answers. They should be astute, good listeners, and understand the situation, environment, players, and people. Just because they were successful elsewhere doesn't mean they fully understand the current work situation. Preconceived notions can lead nowhere. Adapting to the situation and needs without manipulating players, coaches, or management is the mark of a thoroughbred professional.

One of the biggest mistakes in a new workplace is assuming that what worked elsewhere will always work again. There is no one-size-fits-all solution. What they think they know about a team or its athletes may be

completely inaccurate. They may need to adjust their strategies and plans as new information comes to light.

8. Currying favour

Building relationships with key people, not just in the coaching profession but within the ecosystem, is important for growth. However, building relationships with no strings attached and adding value to others without expecting something in return is a noble ideal, more common in stories than in reality.

Once the team dynamics among decision-makers and influencers are understood, the coin can be moved surreptitiously to curry favour and become a key figure within the team. This can trigger a chain reaction that ultimately affects the team's performance in the long run, leading to a serious appetite for destruction.

9. Worrying about the next job

The best time is where they're currently coaching. This doesn't mean they won't progress in their profession, but they must remember that their current job is their most

important responsibility for future opportunities.

Sure, they'd love to make more money, earn a promotion, or coach in a better situation or team, but when they focus on those things, they miss out on much of what their current job offers. The tendency to short-change their athletes and give less than their best might creep in.

The best way to prepare for a future job is to excel in the current one by making their athletes and fellow coaches better. When they genuinely add value to those around them, they create the best prospects for future opportunities.

10. Not learning from others' mistakes

The late American humorist Sam Levenson said, "Learn from the mistakes of others. Life is too short to make them all yourself." Even the best coaches make mistakes, but if they approach a new job with their eyes wide open, mouths shut when required, and are well-prepared, they'll have a better chance to succeed.

Inspirational: Xabi

Alonso had an immediate impact on Bayer Leverkusen's fortunes after leading the club to its first Bundesliga title in his first outing as its head coach last season. AFP

